



Cambridge (CIE) IGCSE Maths: Extended



Your notes

Further Graphs & Tangents

Contents

- * Types of Graphs
- * Drawing Graphs from Tables
- * Solving Equations from Graphs
- * Finding Gradients of Tangents



Your notes

Types of Graphs

Types of Graphs

What types of graphs do I need to know?

- You need to be able to **recognise, sketch, and interpret** the following types of graph:

- **Linear** ($y = \pm x$)

- $y = mx + c$ or $ax + by = c$

- **Quadratic** ($y = \pm x^2$)

- $y = ax^2 + bx + c$

- **Cubic** ($y = \pm x^3$)

- $y = ax^3 + b$ or $y = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx$

- **Reciprocal** ($y = \pm \frac{1}{x}$)

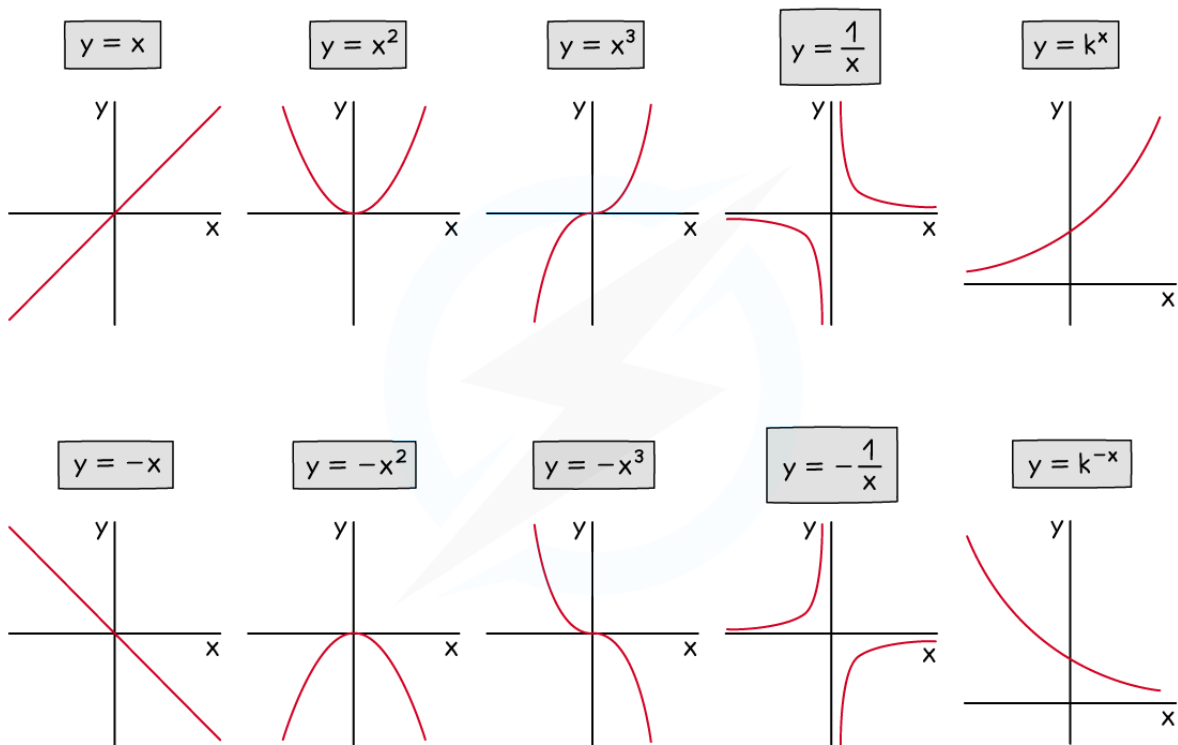
- $y = \frac{a}{x} + b$

- **Exponential** ($y = k^{\pm x}$)

- $y = ak^x + b$

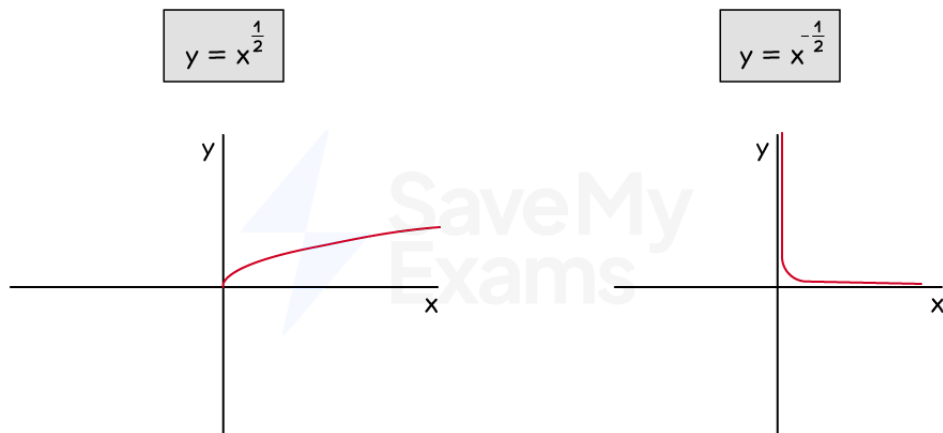


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- You may also need to recognise the graphs $y = x^{\frac{1}{2}}$ and $y = x^{-\frac{1}{2}}$
- These are equivalent to $y = \sqrt{x}$ and $y = \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}}$



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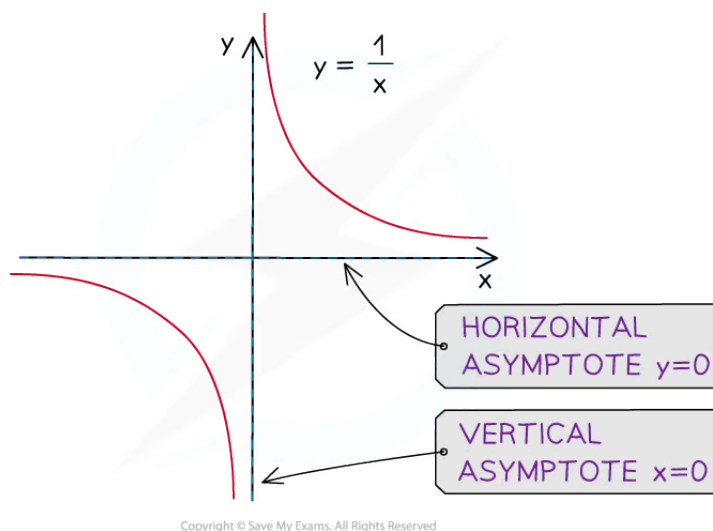
- You must also be able to recognise the three basic **trigonometric graphs**, covered in the Trigonometry section



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Where are the asymptotes on reciprocal graphs?

- An **asymptote** is a line on a graph that a curve becomes closer to but never touches
 - These may be horizontal or vertical
- The **reciprocal** graph, $y = \frac{a}{x}$ (where a is a constant)
 - does not have a y -intercept
 - and does not have any roots
- This graph has **two asymptotes**
 - A **horizontal** asymptote at the x -axis: $y = 0$
 - This is the **limiting value** when the value of x gets very large (or very negative)
 - A **vertical** asymptote at the y -axis: $x = 0$
 - This is the value that causes the **denominator to be zero**



- The reciprocal graph, $y = \frac{a}{x} + b$ (where a and b are both constants)

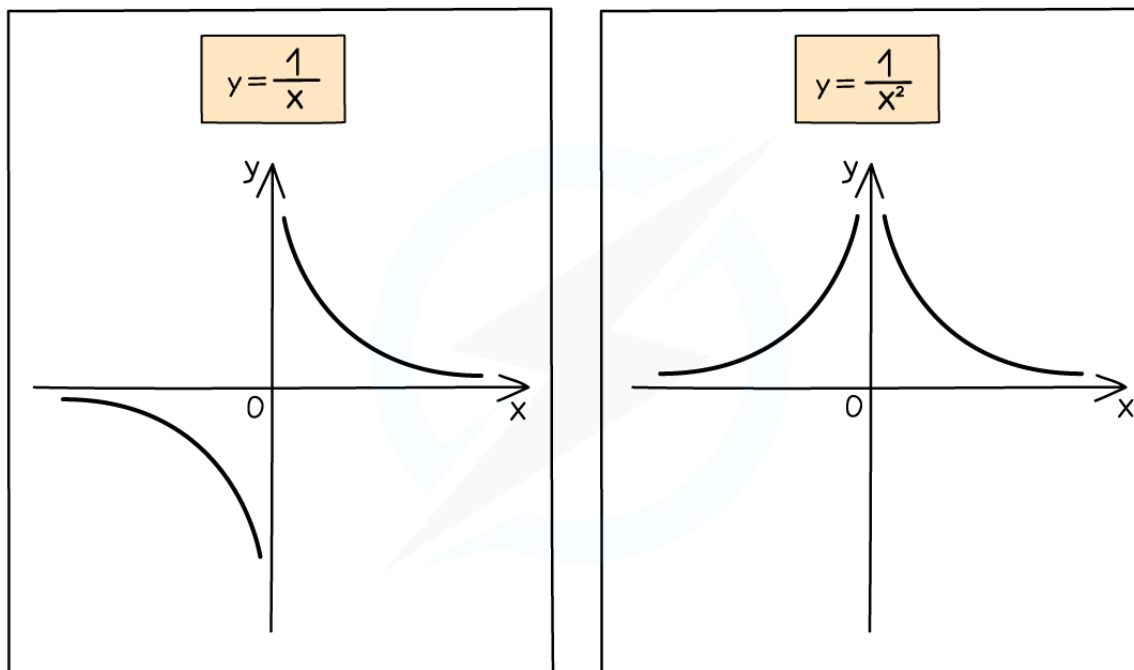


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- is the **same shape** as $y = \frac{a}{x}$
- but is **shifted upwards** by b units
 - $y = \frac{a}{x} - 3$ would be $y = \frac{a}{x}$ shifted **down** by 3 units
- This means the **horizontal asymptote** also **shifts up** by b units
 - The **vertical asymptote** remains on the **y-axis**
- The graph of $y = \frac{1}{x^2}$ is similar to $y = \frac{1}{x}$ but has two key differences
 - $y = \frac{1}{x^2}$ is **steeper** than $y = \frac{1}{x}$
 - $y = \frac{1}{x^2}$ is **always positive**, even when x is negative



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How do I draw exponential growth and decay?

- The equation $y = k^x$ represents **exponential growth** when $k > 1$
 - $y = k^x$ represents **exponential decay** when $0 < k < 1$
 - k is positive but **less than 1**
- Both of these graphs:
 - have a **horizontal asymptote** at $y = 0$
 - **do not** have a **vertical asymptote**
 - have a **y-intercept** of $(0, 1)$
- The graph of $y = ak^x + b$ is a similar shape to $y = k^x$, but there are some differences
 - It is first **stretched** vertically by a



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- It is then **shifted** b units upwards
 - Therefore it has a **horizontal asymptote** at $y = b$
 - and a y -intercept of $(0, a + b)$
- For example, a population may be modelled as $y = 400 \times \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^x + 100$, where y is the population and x represents time
 - This is an exponential decay as $0 < k < 1$
 - The initial population (when $x = 0$) will be $400 + 100 = 500$
 - The y -intercept is $(0, 500)$
 - Over a long period of time (large x -value) the population will settle to 100
 - The asymptote is at $y = 100$
- **Exponential decay** can also be identified by a **negative power** using **index laws**
 - $\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^x = (2^{-1})^x = 2^{-x}$ so $y = 400 \times 2^{-x} + 100$ is the model above
 - This has the form $y = k^{-x}$ where $k > 1$

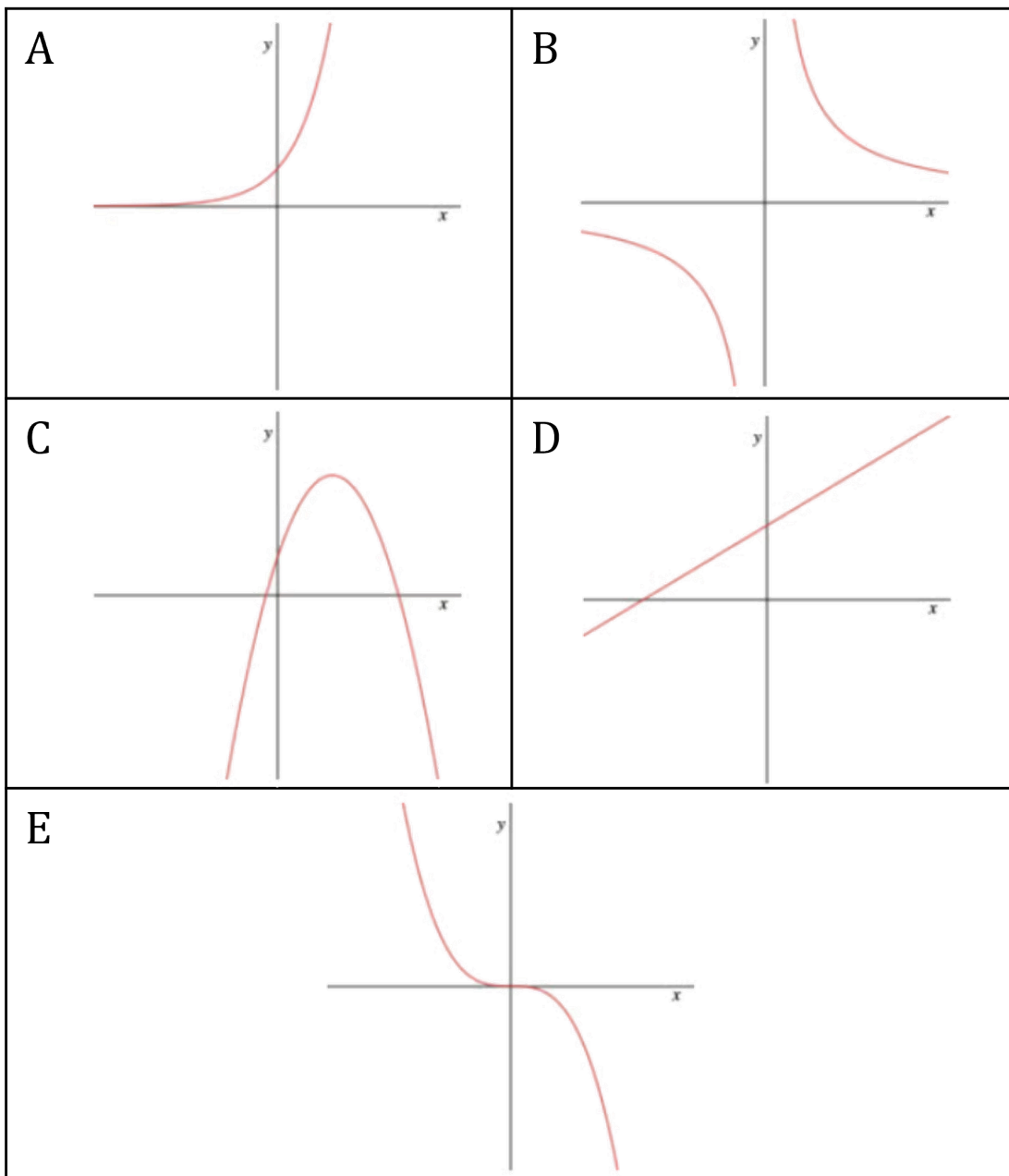


Worked Example

Match the graphs to the equations.



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(1) $y = 0.6x + 2$, (2) $y = 3^x$, (3) $y = -0.7x^3$, (4) $y = \frac{4}{x}$, (5) $y = -x^2 + 3x + 2$

Starting with the equations,



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- (1) is a linear equation ($y = mx + c$) so matches the only straight line, graph D
- (2) is an exponential equation with a positive coefficient so matches graph A
- (3) is a cubic equation with a negative coefficient so matches graph E
- (4) is a reciprocal equation with a positive coefficient so matches graph B
- (5) is a quadratic equation with a negative coefficient so matches graph C

Graph A → Equation 2

Graph B → Equation 4

Graph C → Equation 5

Graph D → Equation 1

Graph E → Equation 3



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Drawing Graphs from Tables

Drawing Graphs Using a Table

How do I draw a graph using a table of values?

- To create a **table of values**
 - **substitute** different **x-values** into the **equation**
 - This gives the **y-values**
- To plot the points
 - use the x and y-values to mark **crosses** on the grid at the **coordinates (x, y)**
 - Each point is expected to be plotted to **an accuracy within half of the smallest square** on the grid
- **Draw a single smooth freehand** curve
 - Go through **all** the plotted **points**
 - Make it the **shape** you would **expect**
 - For example, **quadratic** curves have a vertical line of **symmetry**
 - Do **not** use a ruler for curves!

Which numbers should I be careful with?

- For **quadratic** graphs, be careful substituting in **negative** numbers
 - Always put **brackets** around negative values and use **BIDMAS**
 - For example, substitute $x = -3$ into $y = -x^2 + 8x$
 - This becomes $y = -(-3)^2 + 8(-3)$
 - which simplifies to $-9 - 24$
 - so $y = -33$
- For **reciprocal** graphs like $y = \frac{1}{x}$, or $y = \frac{1}{x^2}$, do **not** include $x = 0$
 - You **cannot divide** by **zero**
 - You get an **error** on your **calculator**



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- There is **no value** at $x = 0$
 - The L-shaped branches **can't cross** the **y-axis**
 - There will be a **vertical asymptote** at $x = 0$

- An example is given below with $y = \frac{1}{x}$

x	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3
y	$-\frac{1}{3}$	$-\frac{1}{2}$	-1	No value	1	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{3}$

- You should also be careful when there is a **combination of different types of function**
 - E.g. $y = x^2 - \frac{1}{x} + 4$ has a quadratic term and a reciprocal term
 - This makes it **harder to know the shape** of the graph
 - But you can still **use a table of values** to plot them
 - Just be aware of points like $x = 0$ as described above, where there will be no value

How do I use the table function on my calculator?

- Calculators** can create **tables of values** for you
- Find the **table** function
 - Type in the **graph** equation (called the **function**, $f(x)$)
 - Use the alpha button then X or x
 - Press = when finished
 - If you are asked for another function, $g(x)$, press = to ignore it
- Enter the **start** value
 - The first x-value in the table
 - Press =
- Enter the **end** value
 - The last x-value in the table

- Enter the **step size**
 - How big the steps (gaps) are from one x -value to the next
 - Press =
- Then scroll up and down to see all the **y -values**



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Examiner Tips and Tricks

- If you find a point that doesn't seem to fit the shape of the curve, check your working!
- If any y -values are given in the question, check that your calculations agree with them



Worked Example

(a) Complete the table of values for the graph of $y = 10 - 8x^2$.

x	-1.5	-1	-0.5	0	0.5	1	1.5
y		2					-8

Use the table function on your calculator for $f(x) = 10 - 8x^2$

Start at -1.5, end at 1.5 and use steps of 0.5

Alternatively, substitute the x -values into the equation, for example $x = -1.5$

$$\begin{aligned}
 y &= 10 - 8(-1.5)^2 \\
 &= 10 - 8 \times 2.25 \\
 &= 10 - 18 \\
 &= -8
 \end{aligned}$$

x	-1.5	-1	-0.5	0	0.5	1	1.5
y	-8	2	8	10	8	2	-8

(b) Plot the graph of $y = 10 - 8x^2$ on the axes below, for values of x from -1.5 to 1.5.

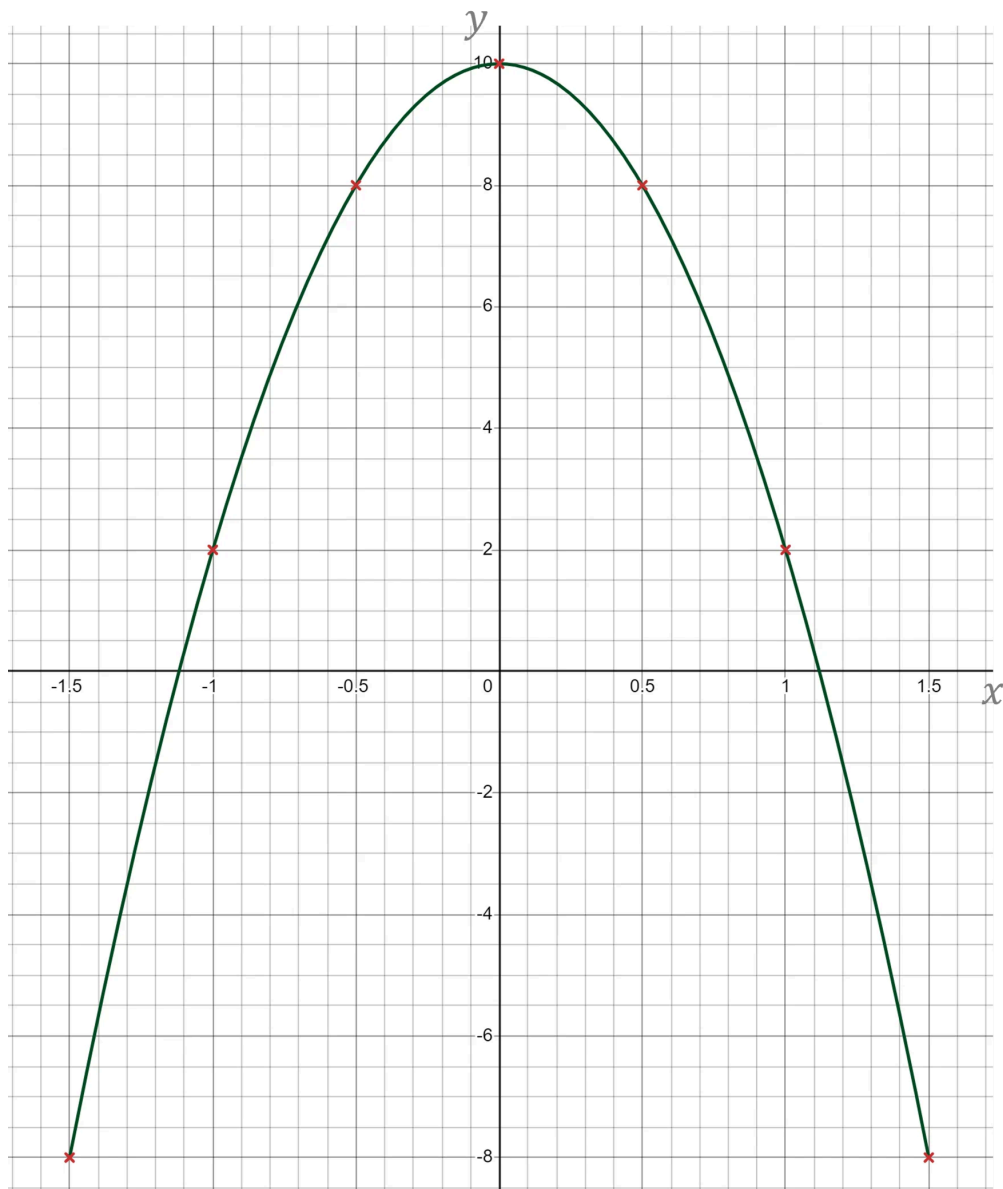
Carefully plot the points from your table on to the grid

Note the different scales on the axes

Join the points with a smooth curve (do not use a ruler)



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(c) Write down the equation of the line of symmetry of the curve.

There is a vertical line of symmetry about the y-axis

The equation of the y-axis is $x = 0$

$x = 0$ 

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Solving Equations from Graphs

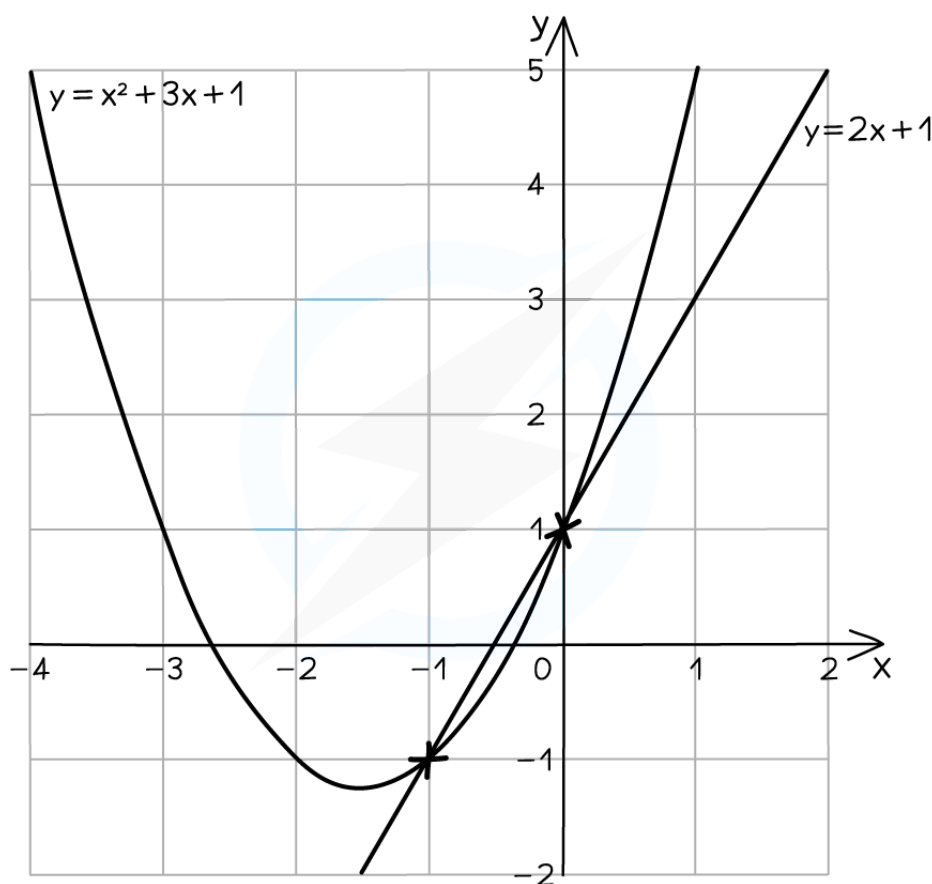


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Solving Equations Using Graphs

How do I find the coordinates of points of intersection?

- Plot **two graphs** on the **same** set of **axes**
 - The **points of intersection** are where the two lines **meet**
- For example, plot $y = x^2 + 3x + 1$ and $y = 2x + 1$ on the same axes
 - They meet twice, as shown
 - The **coordinates of intersection** are $(-1, -1)$ and $(0, 1)$



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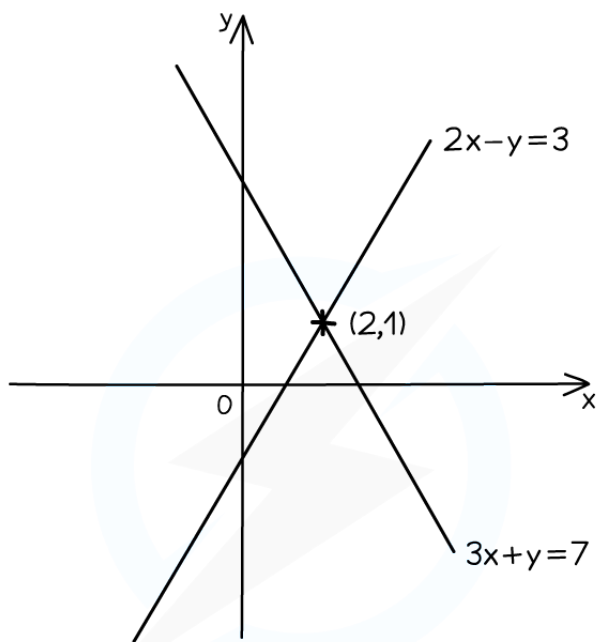




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How do I solve simultaneous equations graphically?

- The **x** and **y** **solutions** to **simultaneous equations** are the **x** and **y** **coordinates** of the **point of intersection**
- For example, to solve $2x - y = 3$ and $3x + y = 7$ simultaneously
 - **Rearrange** them into the form **$y = mx + c$**
 - $y = 2x - 3$ and $y = -3x + 7$
 - Use a **table of values** to plot each line
 - Find the **point of intersection**, (2, 1)
 - The **solutions** are therefore $x = 2$ and $y = 1$



- LINES INTERSECT AT (2,1)
- SOLVING $2x - y = 3$ AND $3x + y = 7$ SIMULTANEOUSLY IS $x = 2$, $y = 1$

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How do I use graphs to solve equations?

- This is easiest explained through an example
- You can use the **graph** of $y = x^2 - 4x - 2$ to **solve** the following **equations**
 - $x^2 - 4x - 2 = 0$
 - The **solutions** are the two **x-intercepts**
 - This is where the curve cuts the x-axis (also called **roots**)
 - $x^2 - 4x - 2 = 5$
 - The **solutions** are the two **x-coordinates** where the curve **intersects** the **horizontal line** $y = 5$
 - $x^2 - 4x - 2 = x + 1$
 - The **solutions** are the two **x-coordinates** where the curve **intersects** the **straight line** $y = x + 1$
 - The straight line must be **plotted** on the same axes first
- To solve a **different** equation like $x^2 - 4x + 3 = 1$, if you are **already given** the graph of an equation, e.g. $y = x^2 - 4x - 2$
 - **add / subtract terms** to both sides to get "given graph = ..."
 - For example, subtract 5 from both sides
 - $x^2 - 4x - 2 = -4$
 - You can now draw on the horizontal line $y = -4$ and find the x-coordinates of the points of intersection



Examiner Tips and Tricks

- When solving equations in x, only give **x-coordinates** as final answers
 - Include the y-coordinates if solving simultaneous equations



Worked Example

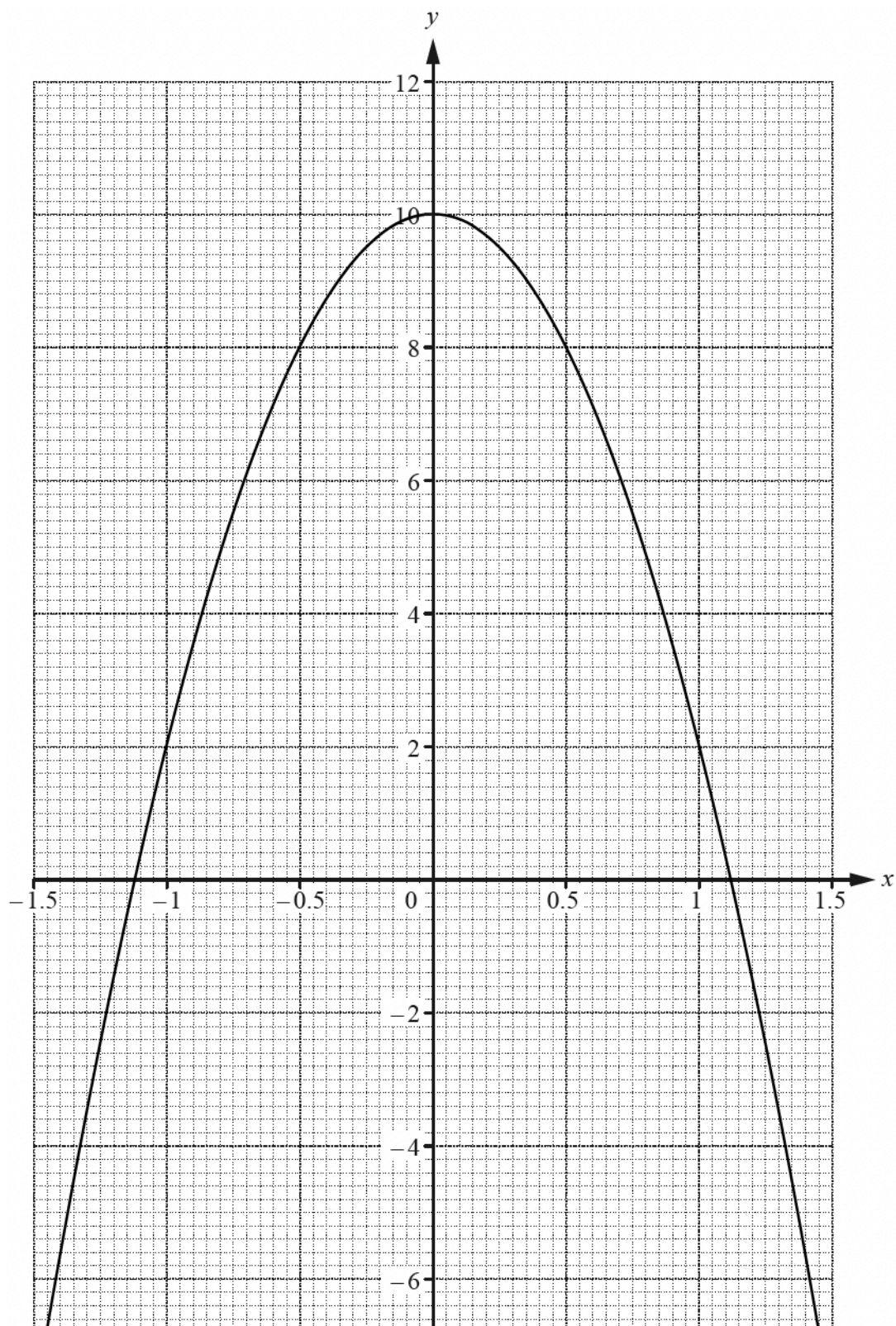
Use the graph of $y = 10 - 8x^2$ shown to estimate the solutions of each equation given below.

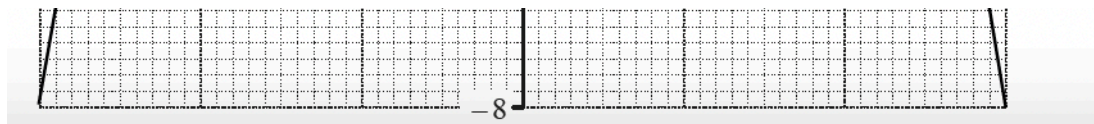
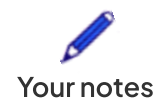


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(a) $10 - 8x^2 = 0$

This equals zero, so the x-intercepts are the solutions

Read off the values where the curve cuts the x-axis

Use a suitable level of accuracy (no more than 2 decimal places from the scale of this graph)

$$-1.12 \text{ and } 1.12$$

These are the two solutions to the equation

$$x = -1.12 \text{ and } x = 1.12$$

A range of solutions are accepted, such as "between 1.1 and 1.2"

Solutions must be $\pm$ of each other (due to the symmetry of quadratics)

(b) $10 - 8x^2 = 8$

This equals 8, so draw the horizontal line $y = 8$

Find the x-coordinates where this cuts the graph

$$-0.5 \text{ and } 0.5$$

These are the two solutions to the original equation

$$x = -0.5 \text{ and } x = 0.5$$

The solutions here are exact



Worked Example

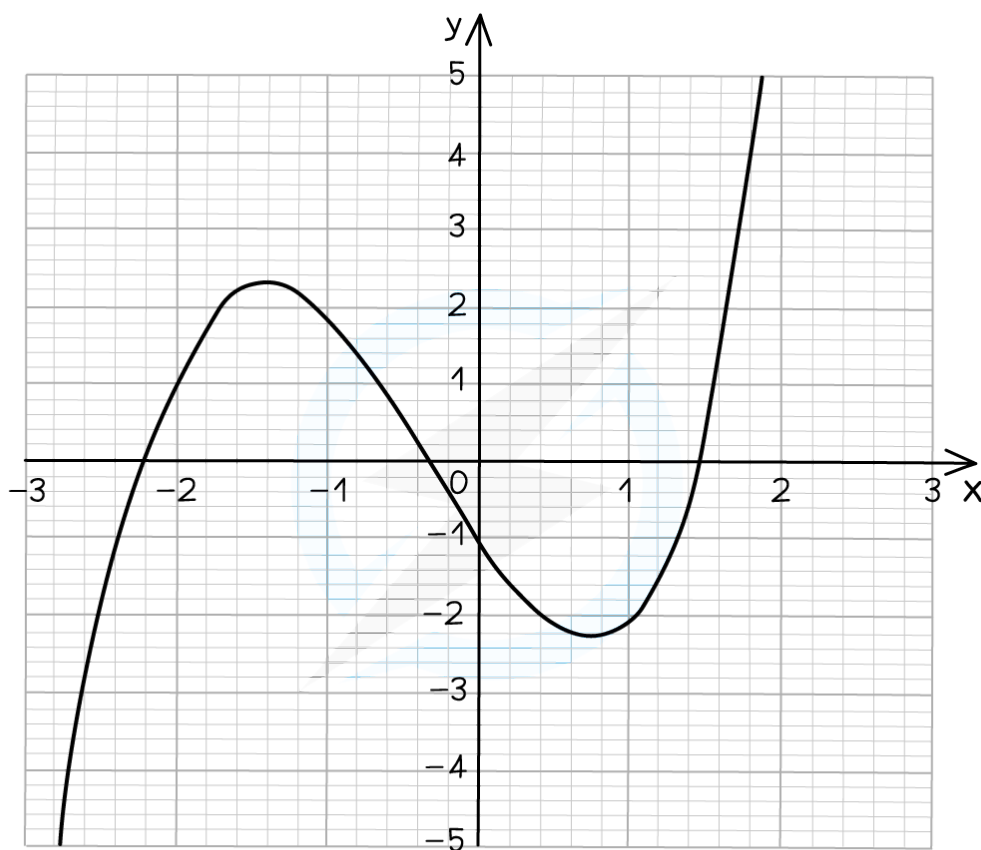
The graph of $y = x^3 + x^2 - 3x - 1$ is shown below.

Use the graph to estimate the solutions of the equation $x^3 + x^2 - 4x = 0$.

Give your answers to 1 decimal place.



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We are given a different equation to the one plotted so we must rearrange it to $\text{graph} = mx + c$,
in this case $x^3 + x^2 - 3x - 1 = mx + c$

$$x^3 + x^2 - 4x = 0$$

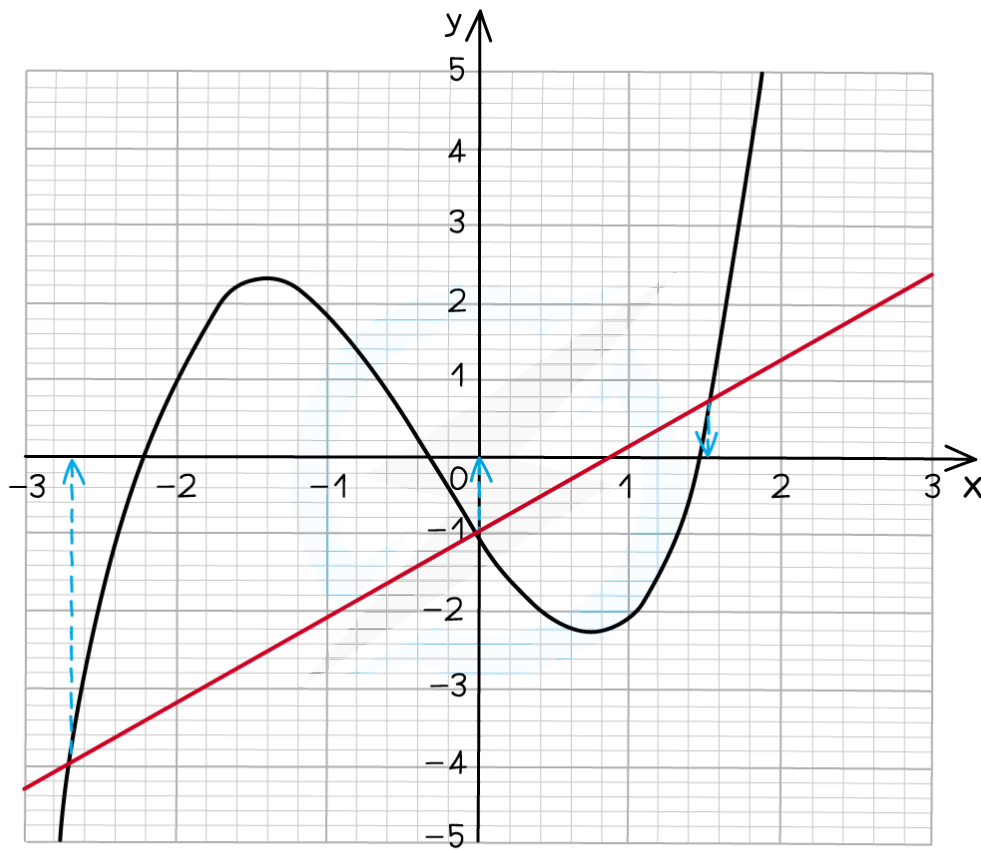
$$+x - 1 \qquad \qquad +x - 1$$

$$x^3 + x^2 - 3x + 1 = x - 1$$

Now plot $y = x - 1$ on the same axes



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The solutions are the x -coordinates of where the curve and the straight line intersect

$$x = -2.6, \quad x = 0, \quad x = 1.6$$

Finding Gradients of Tangents



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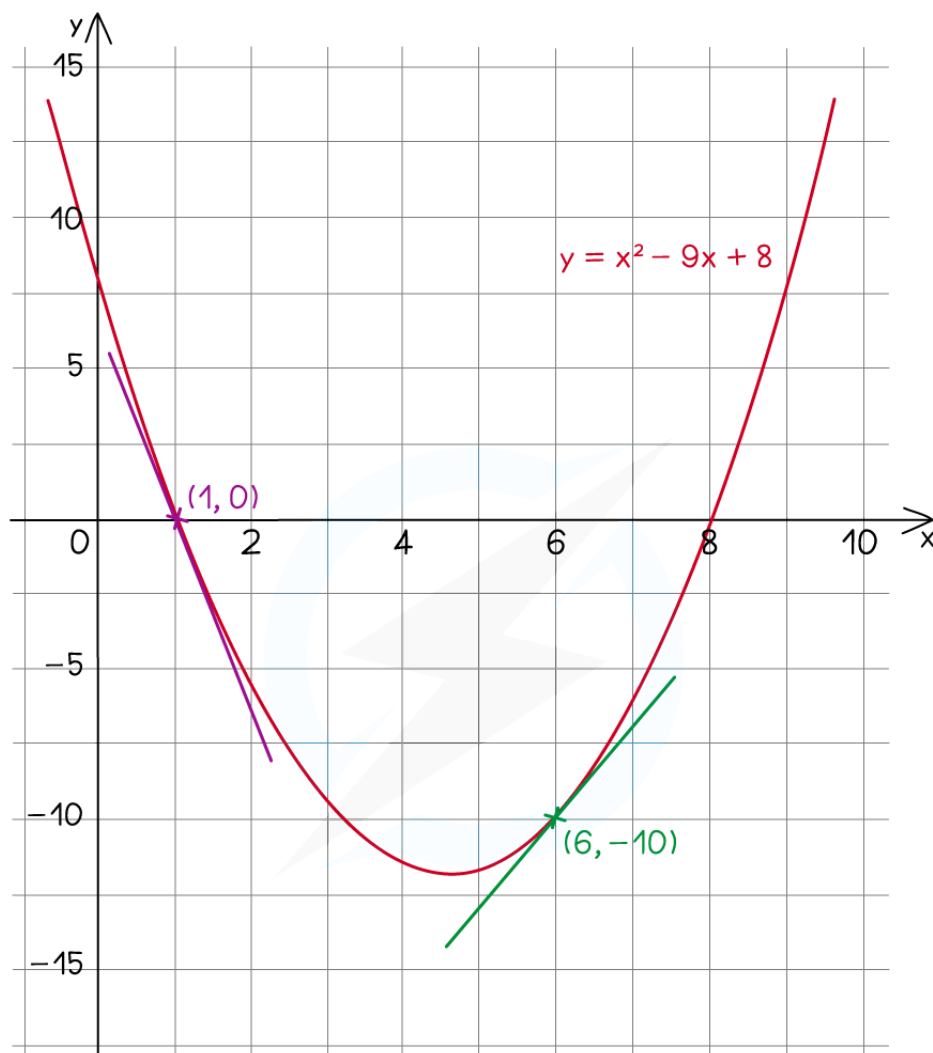
Finding Gradients of Tangents

How are the gradients of graphs and tangents related?

- The **gradient of a graph at a point** is **equal** to the **gradient of the tangent** to the curve **at that point**
 - A tangent is a line that touches a curve, but does not cross it



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THE GRADIENT OF THE CURVE AT THE POINT $x = 1$ WILL BE EQUAL TO THE GRADIENT OF THE PURPLE TANGENT.
THE GRADIENT OF THE CURVE AT THE POINT $x = 6$ WILL BE EQUAL TO THE GRADIENT OF THE GREEN TANGENT.

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How do I estimate the gradient of a curve using a tangent?

- To find an **estimate** for the **gradient** of a curve **at a point**:
 - Draw a **tangent** to the curve at the **point**



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- Find the **gradient of the tangent** using

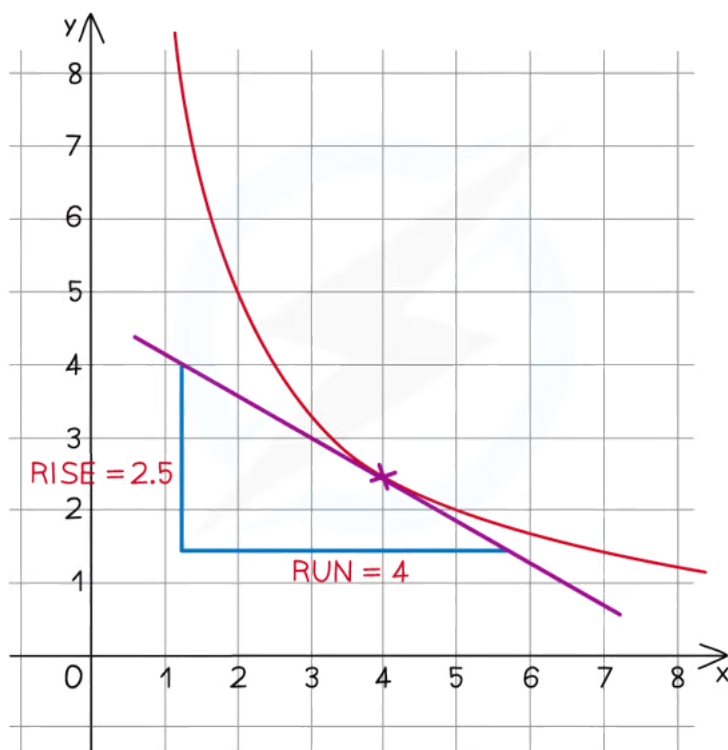
- Gradient = rise ÷ run**

- or difference in $y \div$ difference in x

- In the example below, the **gradient of the tangent** at $x = 4$ would be $\frac{-2.5}{4} = -0.625$

- Remember that the rise is **negative** if it is going down

- This means the **gradient of the curve** at $x = 4$ is **also -0.625**



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- It is an **estimate** because the **tangent** has been drawn by eye and is not exact

- To find the exact gradient we would need to use **differentiation**

What does the gradient represent?

- The gradient represents the **rate of change** of y with x
 - I.e. For every increase in x by 1, how much does y increase?
- Consider the quantities used for the axes to determine the meaning of the gradient



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- In a **distance–time graph**, the gradient is the rate of change of distance with time
 - This is the **speed**
- In a **speed–time graph**, the gradient is the rate of change of speed with time
 - This is the **acceleration**
- In a **graph of volume against radius**, e.g. as a balloon is inflated, the gradient is the rate of change of volume as the radius increases



Examiner Tips and Tricks

- When drawing a tangent by hand:
 - Use a ruler
 - Draw the line as long as you can
- When finding the gradient of the tangent:
 - Pick two points that are far away from one another
 - This will reduce the effect of any inaccuracy



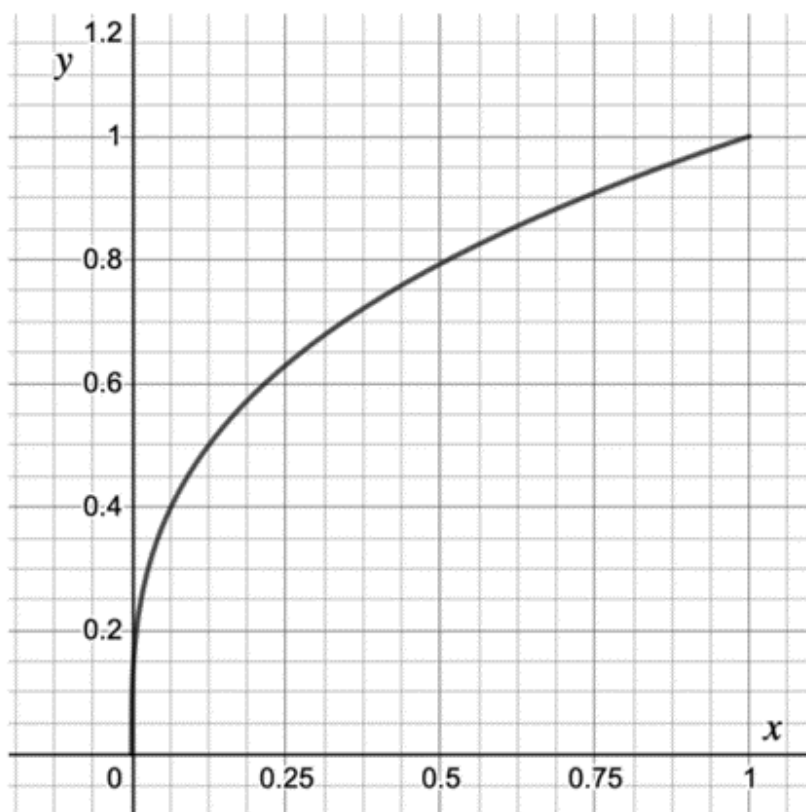
Worked Example

The graph below shows $y = \sqrt[3]{x}$ for $0 \leq x \leq 1$.

Find an estimate of the gradient of the curve at the point where $x = 0.5$.



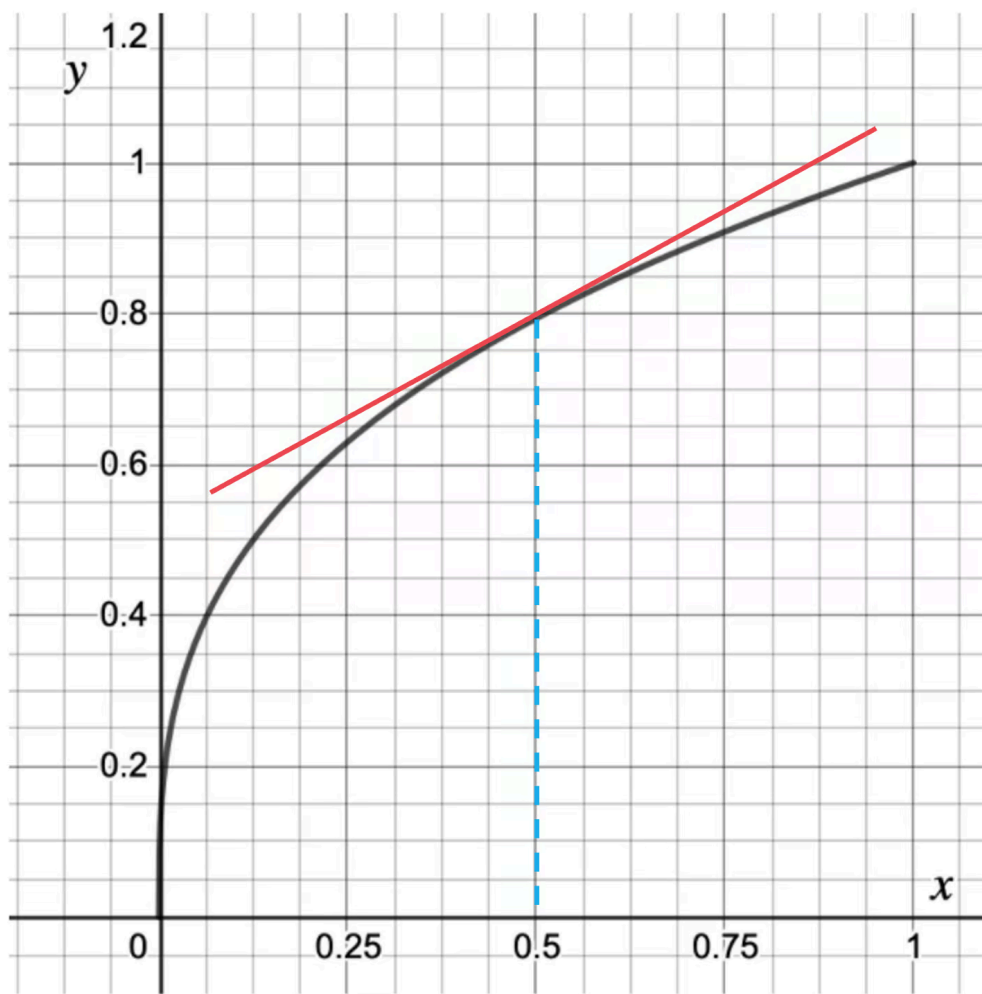
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Draw a tangent to the curve at the point where $x = 0.5$



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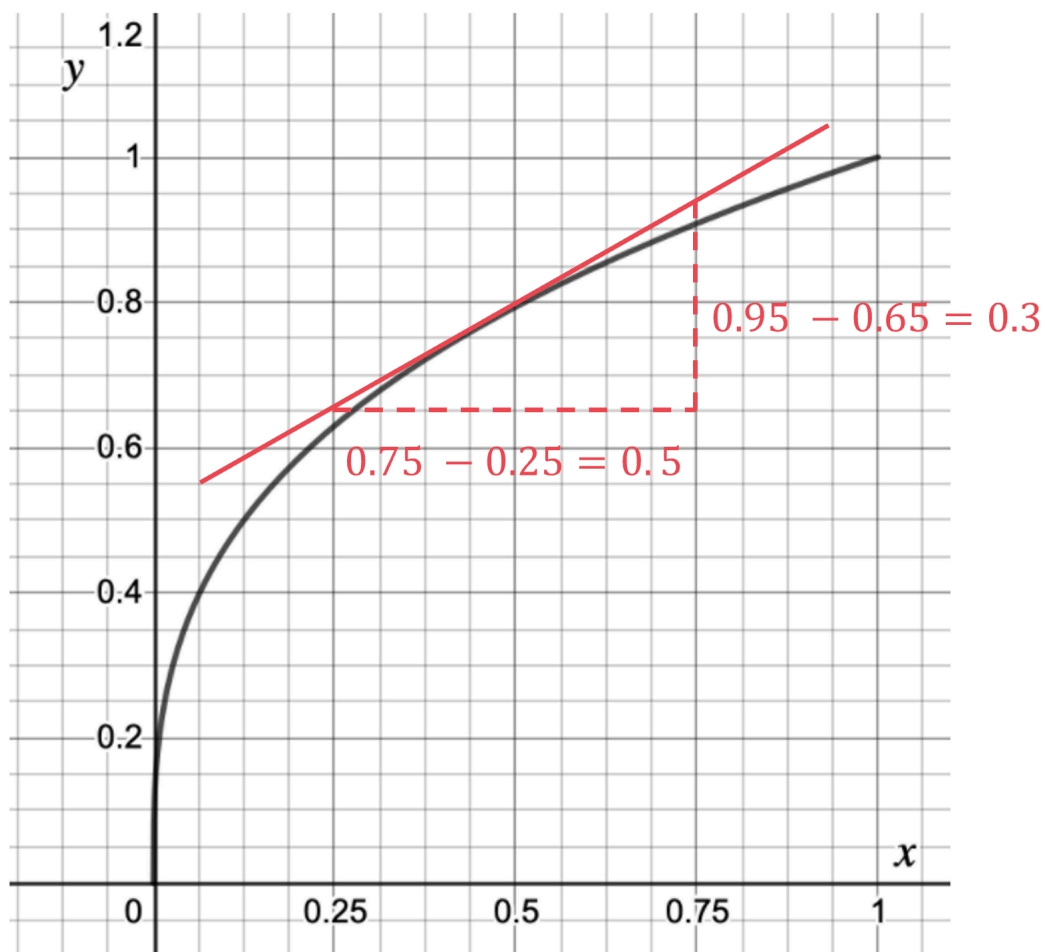


Find suitable, easy to read coordinates as far apart as possible and draw a right-angled triangle between them

Find the difference in the y coordinates (rise) and the difference in the x coordinates (run).



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Find the gradient by dividing the difference in y (rise) by the difference in x

$$\text{Gradient} = \frac{0.3}{0.5} = \frac{3}{5} = 0.6$$

The gradient of the tangent at $x = 0.5$ is equal to the gradient of the curve at $x = 0.5$

Estimate of gradient = 0.6